

GED Social Studies Practice Test 12

PART A — QUESTIONS

GED-SOC12-001

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Reading for Meaning in Social Studies

Prompt:

Source:

A federal transportation program offers states money to repair bridges, but states must contribute 20% of each project's cost. Supporters say this arrangement helps national and state governments share responsibility for infrastructure. Critics say poorer states may struggle to provide the matching funds.

Which civic issue is most directly shown by this source?

- A) Shared federal-state responsibility for public projects
- B) Direct election of federal judges
- C) State power to conduct foreign diplomacy
- D) Private control of congressional spending

GED-SOC12-002

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Economics

Skill: Using Numbers and Graphs in Social Studies

Prompt:

A borrower compares two loan offers.

Loan: A, B

Amount borrowed: \$5,000, \$5,000

Annual interest rate: 8%, 6%

Loan fee: \$50, \$220

Which statement is best supported by the table?

- A) Loan B has the lower interest rate but the higher loan fee.
- B) Loan A has both the lower interest rate and the lower loan fee.
- C) Loan B has the higher interest rate and the lower loan fee.
- D) The two loans have the same interest rate and fee.

GED-SOC12-003

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: U.S. History

Skill: Analyzing Historical Events and Arguments

Prompt:

Source:

In the 1960s and 1970s, Mexican American activists organized school walkouts, voter registration drives, farmworker boycotts, and community newspapers. They argued for better education, fair labor conditions, political representation, and respect for cultural identity.

Which broader historical pattern is best reflected in the source?

- A) Civil rights activism included demands for cultural recognition and local political power.
- B) Mexican American activism focused only on foreign policy.
- C) Farmworkers avoided using boycotts or public organizing.
- D) Community newspapers had no role in social movements.

GED-SOC12-004

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Geography and the World

Skill: Reading for Meaning in Social Studies

Prompt:

A described map shows a mineral-rich plateau, a coastal port, and a rail line connecting them. Mining towns are located on the plateau, while export warehouses and shipping companies are clustered near the port.

Which geographic relationship best explains this pattern?

- A) Transportation links connect inland resources to global markets.
- B) Ports are unrelated to export industries.
- C) Mining towns always develop far from mineral deposits.
- D) Rail lines prevent goods from reaching coastal areas.

GED-SOC12-005

Section: Social Studies

Type: multi_select

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Analyzing Historical Events and Arguments

Prompt:

Select TWO answers.

A federal law requires states to meet certain standards for highway safety. States that meet the standards remain eligible for a specific grant program. States that do not meet the standards may lose part of that grant funding.

Which TWO statements best explain the federalism issue in this situation?

- A) Federal funding can encourage states to adopt certain policies.
- B) States may face practical pressure when grant money is tied to conditions.
- C) Federal grants allow states to declare war.
- D) State governments cannot receive money from the national government.
- E) Grant conditions eliminate all state authority over highways.

GED-SOC12-006

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Reading for Meaning in Social Studies

Prompt:

Paired sources:

Source A:

A city official supports a local rule requiring large apartment buildings to include some lower-rent

units. The official says the city faces a housing shortage and that local governments should be able to respond to local housing needs.

Source B:

A state official opposes different city rules for each municipality. The official argues that complex local requirements discourage construction and that statewide housing rules would make costs more predictable for builders.

What is the main disagreement between the two sources?

- A) Whether housing policy should be shaped mainly by local requirements or statewide uniformity
- B) Whether apartment buildings should be replaced by courthouses
- C) Whether cities may conduct foreign trade negotiations
- D) Whether voters should be forbidden from renting homes

GED-SOC12-007

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: U.S. History

Skill: Reading for Meaning in Social Studies

Prompt:

Source:

In the late 1960s and early 1970s, growing concern about polluted rivers, smog, pesticides, and industrial waste led to public demonstrations and new environmental laws. Supporters argued that economic growth should not come at the cost of public health and natural resources.

Which historical development is most clearly described?

- A) The rise of modern environmental reform
- B) The beginning of colonial settlement
- C) The end of all industrial production
- D) The creation of the first political parties

GED-SOC12-008

Section: Social Studies

Type: dropdown

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Reading for Meaning in Social Studies

Prompt:

When the national government requires states to carry out a policy but does not provide enough money to cover the cost, the requirement is often called [D1]. This issue is most closely connected to debates over [D2].

Dropdowns:

D1) an unfunded mandate | judicial review | naturalization

D2) federalism | jury selection | treaty approval

GED-SOC12-009

Section: Social Studies

Type: numeric_entry

Category: Economics

Skill: Using Numbers and Graphs in Social Studies

Prompt:

A household earns \$4,800 per month before taxes. Its monthly debt payments are \$1,200. What

percent of monthly income goes to debt payments?

Type your answer as a whole number percent without the percent sign.

GED-SOC12-010

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Geography and the World

Skill: Analyzing Historical Events and Arguments

Prompt:

A region shares borders with two countries experiencing conflict. Several towns near the border receive large numbers of displaced families. Local schools add temporary classrooms, clinics request more medicine, and housing costs rise.

Which conclusion is best supported by this scenario?

- A) Conflict-driven migration can affect services and housing in receiving communities.
- B) Migration caused by conflict affects only the country people leave.
- C) Border towns are never affected by population movement.
- D) Schools and clinics are unrelated to migration patterns.

GED-SOC12-011

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Analyzing Historical Events and Arguments

Prompt:

A state joins with two neighboring states to manage a shared river basin. The agreement sets rules for water withdrawals and drought planning. Because the river crosses state lines, the agreement requires approval through the proper constitutional process.

Which type of arrangement is being described?

- A) Interstate compact
- B) Naturalization petition
- C) Criminal indictment
- D) Local zoning variance

GED-SOC12-012

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: U.S. History

Skill: Using Numbers and Graphs in Social Studies

Prompt:

A table shows labor force participation for two groups.

Year: 1940, 1960, 1980

Women: 28%, 38%, 52%

Men: 84%, 82%, 77%

Which statement is best supported by the table?

- A) Women's participation increased while men's participation decreased.
- B) Men's participation increased faster than women's participation.

- C) Both groups had the same participation rate in 1980.
- D) Women's participation was highest in 1940.

GED-SOC12-013

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Reading for Meaning in Social Studies

Prompt:

Source:

A county and a city disagree over who must maintain a road that runs through both jurisdictions. State law says counties maintain rural road segments, while cities maintain road segments inside city limits. A state court uses the statute to decide responsibility.

Which civic principle is most clearly shown?

- A) Legal authority can define responsibilities among levels of local government.
- B) Roads are maintained only by federal courts.
- C) Cities and counties may ignore state law.
- D) Local governments can sign international treaties about roads.

GED-SOC12-014

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Economics

Skill: Analyzing Historical Events and Arguments

Prompt:

A country signs a trade agreement that removes many tariffs on manufactured goods. Consumers may see lower prices on some imports, while workers in industries facing new foreign competition worry about job losses.

Which conclusion is best supported by this scenario?

- A) Trade agreements can create benefits for consumers and challenges for some workers.
- B) Removing tariffs always increases prices for consumers.
- C) Trade agreements affect only government officials.
- D) Foreign competition has no effect on domestic industries.

GED-SOC12-015

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Reading for Meaning in Social Studies

Prompt:

Source:

A state constitution requires that public school funding be "adequate and equitable." Some districts argue that the current formula leaves students in low-wealth areas with fewer educational resources. A court reviews whether the funding system meets the state constitutional requirement.

Which civic issue is most directly involved?

- A) Equal and adequate access to public education under state constitutional law
- B) State power to appoint members of Congress

- C) Local authority to conduct foreign policy
- D) The right of private companies to write school laws

GED-SOC12-016

Section: Social Studies

Type: multi_select

Category: U.S. History

Skill: Analyzing Historical Events and Arguments

Prompt:

Select TWO answers.

After World War II, many returning veterans used federal benefits to attend college, buy homes, or receive job training. These programs helped some families enter the middle class, but access was often unequal because of discrimination in housing, lending, and local administration.

Which TWO conclusions are best supported by this description?

- A) Federal benefits helped expand education and homeownership for many veterans.
- B) Discrimination affected how some public benefits were received.
- C) Veterans' benefits were unrelated to postwar economic life.
- D) Every veteran received equal access in every community.
- E) Federal benefits ended all housing discrimination.

GED-SOC12-017

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Geography and the World

Skill: Using Numbers and Graphs in Social Studies

Prompt:

A country reports its main sources of export income.

Source: Oil, Tourism, Coffee, Manufactured goods

Export income: \$32 billion, \$18 billion, \$7 billion, \$25 billion

Which statement is best supported by the data?

- A) Oil produces the most export income, while manufactured goods produce the second most.
- B) Coffee produces more export income than tourism.
- C) Tourism is the largest source of export income.
- D) Manufactured goods produce less export income than coffee.

GED-SOC12-018

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Analyzing Historical Events and Arguments

Prompt:

A state passes a law requiring counties to provide public defenders for low-income defendants in felony cases. Counties argue that the state must help pay because the requirement creates large local costs.

Which issue is most clearly shown?

- A) Tension between state requirements and local funding responsibilities
- B) County power to declare federal laws invalid

- C) City authority to appoint Supreme Court justices
- D) Private control of criminal courts

GED-SOC12-019

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Economics

Skill: Using Numbers and Graphs in Social Studies

Prompt:

A worker's wage and the price index changed over one year.

Year: Last year, This year

Hourly wage: \$20, \$21

Price index: 100, 110

Which statement is best supported by the table?

- A) The worker's wage rose 5%, but prices rose 10%, so purchasing power likely fell.
- B) The worker's wage rose faster than prices, so purchasing power clearly increased.
- C) Prices fell while wages increased.
- D) Wages and prices both stayed the same.

GED-SOC12-020

Section: Social Studies

Type: dropdown

Category: U.S. History

Skill: Reading for Meaning in Social Studies

Prompt:

The Immigration and Nationality Act of 1965 changed U.S. immigration policy by reducing the older national-origins quota system. This contributed to [D1] and reflected debates about [D2].

Dropdowns:

D1) more diverse immigration patterns | the end of all immigration | a return to colonial rule

D2) equality and national identity | railroad subsidies | westward farming

GED-SOC12-021

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Using Numbers and Graphs in Social Studies

Prompt:

A state distributes \$600 million in transportation aid.

Use: Bridge repair, Rural roads, Bus systems, Planning grants

Amount: \$210 million, \$180 million, \$150 million, \$60 million

What share of the aid goes to bridge repair?

- A) 25%
- B) 30%
- C) 35%
- D) 40%

GED-SOC12-022

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Reading for Meaning in Social Studies

Prompt:

Source:

A state requires cities to submit coastal development plans for state review. Cities may decide the details of local zoning, but the state checks whether the plans protect wetlands and public shoreline access required by state law.

Which statement best describes this relationship?

- A) Local planning authority can be limited by statewide environmental standards.
- B) Cities may ignore state environmental law.
- C) State review means cities cannot make any local decisions.
- D) Coastal development plans are written only by federal courts.

GED-SOC12-023

Section: Social Studies

Type: numeric_entry

Category: Geography and the World

Skill: Using Numbers and Graphs in Social Studies

Prompt:

A port handles 18 million tons of cargo in January and 24 million tons in February. By how many million tons did cargo increase?

Type your answer as a whole number.

GED-SOC12-024

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: U.S. History

Skill: Analyzing Historical Events and Arguments

Prompt:

Source:

In the late 1800s, many Native nations faced federal boarding school policies that attempted to replace Native languages and cultural practices with English and Euro-American customs. Families and communities often resisted cultural loss while trying to protect children and traditions.

Which broader issue is shown by the source?

- A) Federal assimilation policies challenged Native cultural survival.
- B) Native communities controlled all federal education policy.
- C) Boarding schools were designed mainly to preserve Native languages.
- D) Cultural policy had no effect on Native communities.

GED-SOC12-025

Section: Social Studies

Type: drag_drop

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Analyzing Historical Events and Arguments

Prompt:

Match each target with the correct tile.

Tiles:

- A) Interstate compact
- B) Unfunded mandate
- C) Matching grant
- D) State constitutional adequacy clause

Targets:

- T1) Federal funding that requires a state or local contribution
- T2) A requirement imposed without enough funding to cover the cost
- T3) An agreement among states approved through the proper constitutional process

GED-SOC12-026

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Economics

Skill: Reading for Meaning in Social Studies

Prompt:

A city issues a request for bids to build a library. Three companies submit prices and timelines. The city chooses a bid that is not the cheapest because it includes stronger safety plans and a shorter completion schedule.

Which economic idea is most clearly shown?

- A) Public purchasing decisions may consider value, quality, and risk, not only the lowest price.
- B) Governments must always choose the cheapest bid.
- C) Timelines and safety plans are unrelated to public spending.
- D) Bidding prevents governments from buying services.

GED-SOC12-027

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Reading for Meaning in Social Studies

Prompt:

A state constitution includes a balanced-budget rule requiring lawmakers to pass a budget in which planned spending does not exceed expected revenue, except under limited emergency conditions.

Which civic purpose is most directly supported by this rule?

- A) Encouraging fiscal discipline in state budgeting
- B) Giving the executive branch power to cancel elections
- C) Preventing lawmakers from collecting any revenue
- D) Allowing courts to spend money without approval

GED-SOC12-028

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Analyzing Historical Events and Arguments

Prompt:

A city wants to ban all street vendors from a downtown district. Vendors argue that the ban is too broad because the city could address crowding by limiting hours, requiring clear walkways, or setting location rules.

Which conclusion is best supported by the vendors' argument?

- A) A regulation may be challenged if a less restrictive approach could address the same public concern.
- B) Cities cannot regulate sidewalks under any circumstances.
- C) Street vendors may ignore all public safety rules.
- D) Courts must always write vendor permits directly.

GED-SOC12-029

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: U.S. History

Skill: Reading for Meaning in Social Studies

Prompt:

Source:

In the 1990s, the expansion of the internet changed how many Americans found information, communicated, shopped, and worked. Supporters saw new economic opportunity and access to knowledge. Critics worried about unequal access, privacy, and misinformation.

Which statement best summarizes the source?

- A) The internet created new opportunities while raising social and policy concerns.
- B) The internet ended all differences in access to information.
- C) Americans stopped using technology in the 1990s.
- D) Privacy concerns disappeared as communication became digital.

GED-SOC12-030

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Using Numbers and Graphs in Social Studies

Prompt:

A state has three revenue sources for a training program.

Source: Federal grant, State funds, Employer fees

Amount: \$12 million, \$9 million, \$3 million

What percent of the total funding comes from employer fees?

- A) 10%
- B) 12.5%
- C) 15%
- D) 25%

GED-SOC12-031

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Reading for Meaning in Social Studies

Prompt:

Source:

A state law lets regional transit authorities include several cities and counties. The authorities can plan bus routes across local boundaries because commuters often live in one city and work in another.

Which civic purpose is most directly supported by regional transit authorities?

- A) Coordinating public services that cross local boundaries
- B) Replacing all city governments with private companies
- C) Allowing counties to issue passports
- D) Giving transit agencies power to write criminal law

GED-SOC12-032

Section: Social Studies

Type: multi_select

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Using Numbers and Graphs in Social Studies

Prompt:

Select TWO answers.

A state compares three county tax bases.

County: A, B, C

Population: 80,000, 120,000, 200,000

Property value per person: \$90,000, \$60,000, \$45,000

Which TWO statements are supported by the data?

- A) County A has the highest property value per person.
- B) County C has the largest population.
- C) County B has the lowest property value per person.
- D) County A has the largest population.
- E) County C has the highest property value per person.

GED-SOC12-033

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Geography and the World

Skill: Analyzing Historical Events and Arguments

Prompt:

A described map shows a shipping chokepoint between two seas. Many oil tankers and container ships pass through the narrow route each day. When the route is blocked, ships must take a longer path around a continent, increasing fuel costs and delivery times.

Which conclusion is best supported by this described map?

- A) Strategic waterways can strongly affect global trade routes and costs.
- B) Narrow waterways have no effect on shipping.
- C) Global trade depends only on air travel.
- D) Longer routes always reduce fuel costs.

GED-SOC12-034

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: U.S. History

Skill: Using Numbers and Graphs in Social Studies

Prompt:

A table shows the share of U.S. workers employed in agriculture.

Year: 1900, 1950, 2000

Share in agriculture: 38%, 12%, 2%

Which statement is best supported by the data?

- A) The share of workers in agriculture decreased over time.
- B) The share of workers in agriculture increased after 1900.
- C) Agriculture employed the largest share of workers in 2000.
- D) The share was the same in 1900 and 2000.

GED-SOC12-035

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Reading for Meaning in Social Studies

Prompt:

Source:

A state constitution says that when public land is leased to private companies, the lease must serve a public purpose and provide fair value to the state. Courts may review whether officials gave away public resources for less than reasonable value.

Which claim is best supported by the source?

- A) Public resources should be managed for public benefit and fair value.
- B) Public land may be transferred for any private benefit without review.
- C) Courts may not consider whether public resources are undervalued.
- D) State constitutions cannot address public land.

PART B — ANSWER KEY + EXPLANATIONS

GED-SOC12-001 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Shared federal-state responsibility for public projects — Explanation: The program uses federal money and state matching funds, showing shared responsibility for infrastructure.

GED-SOC12-002 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Loan B has the lower interest rate but the higher loan fee. — Explanation: Loan B has a 6% rate compared with 8% for Loan A, but its fee is \$220 compared with \$50.

GED-SOC12-003 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Civil rights activism included demands for cultural recognition and local political power. — Explanation: The source describes activism for education, labor rights, representation, and cultural identity.

GED-SOC12-004 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Transportation links connect inland resources to global markets. — Explanation: The rail line links mines on the plateau to warehouses and shipping companies near the port.

GED-SOC12-005 — Correct: A,B — Correct Answer: Federal funding can encourage states to adopt certain policies. | States may face practical pressure when grant money is tied to conditions. — Explanation: Conditional grants are a federalism tool that can influence state policy choices.

GED-SOC12-006 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Whether housing policy should be shaped mainly by local requirements or statewide uniformity — Explanation: Source A supports city requirements, while Source B favors predictable statewide rules.

GED-SOC12-007 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: The rise of modern environmental reform — Explanation: The source describes public concern and new laws related to pollution and environmental protection.

GED-SOC12-008 — Correct: D1=an unfunded mandate; D2=federalism — Correct Answer: D1=an unfunded mandate; D2=federalism — Explanation: An unfunded mandate requires action without enough funding and is often debated in federalism.

GED-SOC12-009 — Correct: 25 — Tolerance: exact — Correct Answer: 25 — Explanation: \$1,200 divided by \$4,800 equals 25%.

GED-SOC12-010 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Conflict-driven migration can affect services and housing in receiving communities. — Explanation: Displaced families increase pressure on schools, clinics, and housing.

GED-SOC12-011 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Interstate compact — Explanation: An agreement among states to manage a shared resource is an interstate compact.

GED-SOC12-012 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Women's participation increased while men's participation decreased. — Explanation: Women's participation rose from 28% to 52%, while men's participation fell from 84% to 77%.

GED-SOC12-013 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Legal authority can define responsibilities among levels of local government. — Explanation: State law determines which local government maintains each road segment.

GED-SOC12-014 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Trade agreements can create benefits for consumers and challenges for some workers. — Explanation: Tariff removal may lower prices but increase competition for domestic industries.

GED-SOC12-015 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Equal and adequate access to public education under state constitutional law — Explanation: The court reviews whether the funding formula meets adequacy and equity requirements.

GED-SOC12-016 — Correct: A,B — Correct Answer: Federal benefits helped expand education and homeownership for many veterans. | Discrimination affected how some public benefits were received. — Explanation: The source shows both the benefits of federal programs and unequal access because of discrimination.

GED-SOC12-017 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Oil produces the most export income, while manufactured goods produce the second most. — Explanation: Oil is highest at \$32 billion, and manufactured goods are second at \$25 billion.

GED-SOC12-018 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Tension between state requirements and local funding responsibilities — Explanation: The state imposes a requirement, while counties face the cost of carrying it out.

GED-SOC12-019 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: The worker's wage rose 5%, but prices rose 10%, so purchasing power likely fell. — Explanation: The wage rose from \$20 to \$21, but the price index rose from 100 to 110.

GED-SOC12-020 — Correct: D1=more diverse immigration patterns; D2=equality and national identity — Correct Answer: D1=more diverse immigration patterns; D2=equality and national identity — Explanation: The 1965 law changed immigration policy and contributed to more diverse immigration patterns.

GED-SOC12-021 — Correct: C — Correct Answer: 35% — Explanation: \$210 million out of \$600 million equals 35%.

GED-SOC12-022 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Local planning authority can be limited by statewide environmental standards. — Explanation: Cities keep local zoning authority, but state review checks compliance with state environmental requirements.

GED-SOC12-023 — Correct: 6 — Tolerance: exact — Correct Answer: 6 — Explanation: Cargo increased from 18 million tons to 24 million tons, a difference of 6 million tons.

GED-SOC12-024 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Federal assimilation policies challenged Native cultural survival. — Explanation: Boarding school policies attempted to replace Native languages and customs, threatening cultural survival.

GED-SOC12-025 — Correct: T1=C; T2=B; T3=A — Correct Answer: T1=Matching grant; T2=Unfunded mandate; T3=Interstate compact — Explanation: Matching grants require shared funding, unfunded mandates impose costs without enough funding, and interstate compacts are agreements among states.

GED-SOC12-026 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Public purchasing decisions may consider value, quality, and risk, not only the lowest price. — Explanation: The city chooses based on safety and timeline as well as price.

GED-SOC12-027 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Encouraging fiscal discipline in state budgeting — Explanation: A balanced-budget rule limits planned spending to expected revenue except in limited emergencies.

GED-SOC12-028 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: A regulation may be challenged if a less restrictive approach could address the same public concern. — Explanation: The vendors argue that targeted rules could address crowding without a total ban.

GED-SOC12-029 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: The internet created new opportunities while raising social and policy concerns. — Explanation: The source describes opportunity, access to knowledge, and concerns about access, privacy, and misinformation.

GED-SOC12-030 — Correct: B — Correct Answer: 12.5% — Explanation: Total funding is \$24 million, and employer fees are \$3 million; $\$3 \text{ million} \div \$24 \text{ million} = 12.5\%$.

GED-SOC12-031 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Coordinating public services that cross local boundaries — Explanation: Regional transit authorities help coordinate services across cities and counties.

GED-SOC12-032 — Correct: A,B — Correct Answer: County A has the highest property value per person. | County C has the largest population. — Explanation: County A has the highest property value per person at \$90,000, and County C has the largest population at 200,000.

GED-SOC12-033 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Strategic waterways can strongly affect global trade routes and costs. — Explanation: A chokepoint affects shipping time and fuel costs when blocked.

GED-SOC12-034 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: The share of workers in agriculture decreased over time. — Explanation: The share fell from 38% in 1900 to 2% in 2000.

GED-SOC12-035 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Public resources should be managed for public benefit and fair value. — Explanation: The source requires public purpose and fair value when leasing public land.